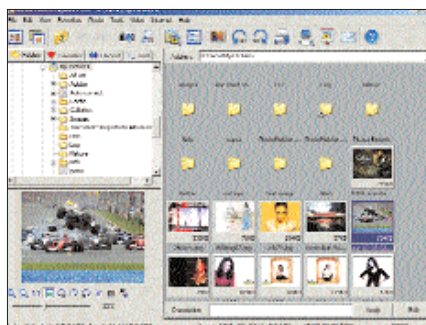




Ulead has a conventional Windows Explorer-style interface

incorrect results due to entries that you aren't aware of. It has the worst tagging feature of all, with no predefined tags, forcing you to enter tags separately. What's worse, you can only add descriptions to images individually, and can only rate them as A, B or C.

Apart from these drawbacks, the software has a good set of features. It comes with a standalone viewer—Ulead Instant Viewer, which can be used as the default viewer. The image editor is also quite impressive and has utilities such as histograms, focus changing, lens distortion, and so on. It also lets you preview

Recover Lost Images

When you delete an image from a digital camera's memory, it isn't actually erased. Like a hard disk, it just deletes the reference to that image. Thus, using a low-level access to the camera's memory, you can recover lost images. There are utilities that allow you to recover the images, but since low level access depends on a lot of things such as the type of memory used and make of the camera, the utility may or may not be successful.

a change before applying the alterations.

The CD catalog feature automatically asks you if you wish to create a catalogue of a CD when you insert a CD with images on it. After you click Yes, the program will go through the entire CD and create a virtual folder. If you select this folder later, you will be asked to insert the corresponding CD. However, you can't view thumbnails of a virtual folder unless the corresponding CD is in the drive.

And the winner is.....

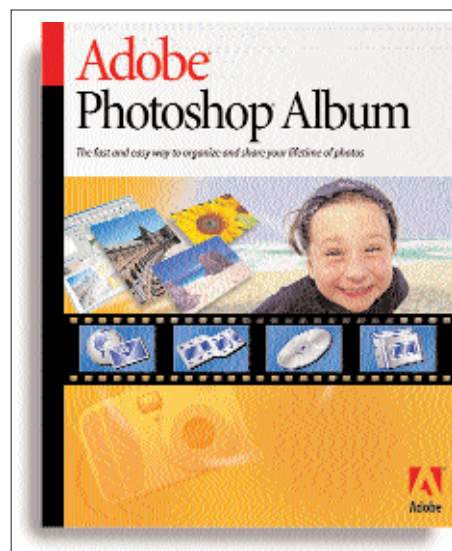
Photoshop Album, Picasa and Prelick Photo Organizer deserve credit for chang-

Zero Assumption Digital Image Recovery, a freeware, lets you recover images, in addition to other shareware tools such as PhotoRescue (www.datarescue.com/photorescue/). The latter can even recover data from memory cards, USB sticks, etc.

We tested these utilities on various cameras and they worked with cameras manufactured by Minolta, Nikon, Fuji and Sony, and not with the ones manufactured by Kodak and Cannon.

ing the conventional interface and bringing in better interfaces, suitable for home users. But traditional players such as ACD, Jasc and Ulead have backed their products with a good set of features.

In the end, Adobe comes out with the honours because it has the best combination of features and user-friend-



liness. Photoshop Album does not offer conventional features such as an image viewer, filters, special effects, and so on, but it lets you to use your images in various ways. Its excellent interface helped hammer in the nails in the coffins of the others.

The other software also show flashes of brilliance; Photo Album has excellent printing support. Those who want to add a lot of effects to images should choose Photo Explorer. If you don't want to spend anything at all, opt for Photo Organizer. But, if you insist on the best, then there's nothing to beat Adobe Photoshop Album... yet.

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